The frog king

In olden times when wishing still *helped* one, there lived a king whose daughters were all beautiful, but the youngest was so beautiful that the sun itself, which has seen so much, was **astonished** whenever it shone in her face.

Close by the king's castle lay a great dark forest, and under an old lime-tree in the forest was a well, and when the day was very warm, the king's child went out into the forest and sat down by the side of the cool ***fountain***, and when she was bored she took a golden ball, and threw it up on high and caught it, and this ball was her favorite plaything.

The golden ball

Now it so happened that on one occasion the princess's golden ball did not fall into the little hand which she was holding up for it, but on to the ground beyond, and rolled straight into the water.

- The king's daughter followed it with her eyes, but it vanished, and the well was deep, so deep that the bottom could not be seen.
- At this she began to cry, and cried louder and louder, and could not be comforted.

1. And as she thus lamented someone called to her, "What ails you, king's daughter? You weep so that even a stone would show pity."
2. She looked round to the side from whence the voice came, and saw a frog stretching forth its big, ugly head from the water.

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